

Why You Need An E-mail Exploit Detection Engine

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Virus-writers are using increasingly complex and sophisticated techniques in their bid to circumvent anti-virus software and disseminate their viruses. A case in point was the notorious Nimda virus that used multiple methods to spread itself and was based on an exploit rather than on the virus/Trojan behaviour that anti-virus products typically search for. Anti-virus software, though essential, cannot combat such threats alone; an e-mail exploit detection tool is also necessary.

What Is An Exploit?

An exploit uses known vulnerabilities in applications or operating systems to execute a program or code. It "exploits" a feature of a program or the operating system for its own use, such as executing arbitrary machine code, read/write files on the hard disk, or gain illicit access.

What Is An E-mail Exploit?

An e-mail exploit is an exploit launched via e-mail. An e-mail exploit is essentially an exploit that can be embedded in an e-mail, and executed on the recipient's machine once the user either opens or receives the e-mail. This allows the hacker to bypass most firewalls and anti-virus products.

The Difference Between Anti-virus Software And E-mail Exploit Detection Software

Anti-virus software is designed to detect known malicious code. An e-mail exploit engine takes a different approach: it analyses the code for exploits that could be malicious. This means it can protect against new viruses, but most importantly against unknown viruses or malicious code. This is crucial as an unknown virus could be a one-off